

Word family: **wear / wears / wore / worn / wearing / wearable / wearer / worn-out**

Base word: wear

Past tense: wore

Past participle: worn

ing form: wearing

Related forms:

* **wearable** (adj.) — 可穿戴的；適合穿着的

* **wearable** (n.) — 穿戴式裝置

* **wearer** (n.) — 穿戴者

* **worn** (adj.) — 磨損的；用舊的

* **worn-out** (adj.) — 磨破的；筋疲力盡的

* **wear** (n.) — 磨損；損耗

Useful extensions:

* **wear clothes / glasses / jewellery**

* **wear a smile / expression**

* **wear your hair long/short**

* **wear well**

* **wear thin**

* **wear away**

* **wear down**

* **wear off**

* **wear out**

* **wear someone out**

* **wear and tear**

* **everyday wear / formal wear / sportswear**

* **wearable technology**

Part of speech: mainly **verb** and **noun**

Meaning in this passage

> Some children are active in a way that **wears people out**, but Leo is different.

Here, the relevant expression is:

wear someone out — 使某人筋疲力盡；把某人累壞

It means that dealing with some very active children can use up another person's physical or mental energy until that person becomes extremely tired.

****中文翻譯：****

有些孩子非常好動，****會把身邊的人累得筋疲力盡****，但 Leo 不一樣。

So here:

* ****wear**** is ****not**** 「穿」

* ****wear out**** is a highly common phrasal extension

* ****wear someone out**** = ****使某人因持續活動、壓力、照顧等而非常疲累****

1. ****wear clothes/shoes etc.** (穿戴) — 穿着；戴着******

This is the most familiar meaning of ****wear****.

Practice 1

> She was ****wearing a blue dress****.

她當時****穿着一條藍色連身裙****。

Practice 2

> You should ****wear comfortable shoes**** for the walk.

這次步行你應該****穿舒適的鞋子****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****wear = 把衣服、鞋子等穿在身上****

2. ****wear glasses / jewellery / a watch etc.** — 戴着******

With accessories and objects worn on the body, Chinese normally uses ****戴**** rather than 穿.

Practice 1

> He ****wears glasses**** when he reads.

他閱讀時會****戴眼鏡****。

Practice 2

> She was **wearing a silver necklace**.

她當時**戴着一條銀色頸鏈**。

MCQ-ready definition:

wear = 把眼鏡、首飾、手錶等物件戴在身上

3. **wear perfume / make-up — 搽着；使用着**

Wear can extend to things applied to the body rather than literally put on like clothes.

Practice 1

> She doesn't usually **wear make-up**.

她平時不太**化妝**。

Practice 2

> He was **wearing a strong perfume**.

他身上**用了氣味很濃的香水**。

MCQ-ready definition:

wear = 把化妝品、香水等用在身上並保持該狀態

4. **wear your hair/beard in a particular way — 留某種髮型 / 鬍鬚造型**

Here **wear** means to have your hair or beard arranged in a particular style.

Practice 1

> She **wears her hair long**.

她**留長髮**。

Practice 2

> He usually **wears his hair tied back**.

他通常把頭髮**束在後面**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****wear your hair/beard + description = 保持某種髮型或鬍鬚造型****

5. ****wear a smile / expression — 面帶某種表情****

A figurative but highly established extension.

Practice 1

> She ****wore a warm smile**** throughout the evening.

整個晚上，她臉上都****帶着溫暖的笑容****。

Practice 2

> He ****wore a puzzled expression**** when he read the message.

他讀到那則訊息時，臉上****露出困惑的表情****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****wear an expression = 臉上呈現或保持某種表情****

6. ****wear a look of confidence/sadness etc. — 顯露某種神情****

Very close to the previous pattern, but worth recognizing as a common construction.

Practice 1

> She ****wore a look of determination****.

她臉上****流露出堅定的神情****。

Practice 2

> He ****wore a look of disappointment**** after hearing the result.

他聽到結果後，臉上****顯出失望的神情****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****wear a look of X = 臉上顯露出某種情緒或態度****

7. ****wear a particular appearance/style — 呈現；帶有某種外在形象****

Less common than literal clothing, but ****wear**** can describe something visibly carried or displayed.

Practice 1

> He ****wears his age well****.

他年紀雖然大，但****外表看起來比實際年齡年輕 / 保養得很好****。

Practice 2

> She ****wears confidence naturally****.

她很自然地****展現出自信****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****wear = 持續呈現某種可見的外表、神情或氣質****

8. ****wear (物件因使用而磨損) — 磨損；磨蝕****

Now we move to a genuinely different semantic branch.

Practice 1

> The carpet has ****worn**** badly near the door.

門附近的地毯已經****磨損得很厲害****。

Practice 2

> These tyres ****wear**** quickly on rough roads.

這些輪胎在崎嶇路面上很快便會****磨損****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****wear = 因長期使用、摩擦或時間而逐漸受損****

9. ****wear something smooth/thin — 把某物磨得光滑 / 變薄****

Here ****wear**** is transitive: repeated friction causes a physical change.

Practice 1

> Years of footsteps had ****worn the stone smooth****.

多年的踩踏把石頭****磨得光滑****。

Practice 2

> Constant rubbing had ****worn the fabric thin****.

持續摩擦把布料****磨得很薄****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****wear something + adjective = 因長期摩擦或使用而使某物逐漸變成某種狀態****

10. ****wear away — 逐漸磨掉；侵蝕****

Practice 1

> The water slowly ****wore away the rock****.

水慢慢把岩石****侵蝕掉****。

Practice 2

> Years of use had ****worn away**** the writing on the sign.

多年使用已把牌上的文字****磨掉了****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****wear away = 因摩擦、侵蝕或時間而逐漸消失或變少****

11. ****wear down something — 逐漸磨薄 / 磨低****

Practice 1

> Walking on the steps for years had ****worn them down****.

多年的踩踏已把那些梯級****磨低了****。

Practice 2

> The constant friction **wore down** the surface.

持續的摩擦把表面逐漸**磨損**。

MCQ-ready definition:

wear something down = 透過長期摩擦或使用使某物逐漸磨損、變薄或變低

12. **wear someone down** — 逐漸消耗某人的精神 / 意志

This develops metaphorically from physical erosion.

Practice 1

> Months of uncertainty slowly **wore her down**.

數月的不確定狀況逐漸**消磨**了她的精神。

Practice 2

> The constant arguments eventually **wore him down**.

持續不斷的爭吵最終**把他折磨得身心疲憊**。

MCQ-ready definition:

wear someone down = 經過一段時間逐漸消耗某人的精力、耐性或抵抗意志

13. **wear someone down until they agree** — 磨到某人讓步

A particularly useful figurative extension.

Practice 1

> The children kept asking until they finally **wore their parents down**.

孩子們一直央求，最後終於**磨到父母讓步**。

Practice 2

> He eventually **wore me down** and I agreed to go.

他一直勸我，最後終於**磨到我答應去**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****wear someone down = 持續施壓、央求或爭辯，直至某人的抵抗減弱而讓步****

14. ****wear out (物件) — 穿破；用壞；磨損至不能再用****

Practice 1

> I've ****worn out**** my favourite shoes.

我已經把我最喜歡的鞋子**穿破了**。

Practice 2

> The machine eventually ****wore out**** after years of use.

那部機器用了多年後終於**耗損至不能再用**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****wear out = 因長期使用而磨損至破舊或不能正常使用****

15. ****be worn out (物件) — 磨損的；用壞的****

Practice 1

> These shoes are completely ****worn out****.

這雙鞋已經完全**穿破 / 穿殘了**。

Practice 2

> We replaced the ****worn-out**** carpet.

我們換掉了那張**嚴重磨損的**地毯。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****worn out = 因使用過久而嚴重磨損、破舊或不能再用的****

16. ****wear someone out — 把某人累壞；使筋疲力盡****

This is the meaning used in your passage.

Practice 1 — original sentence

> Some children are active in a way that ****wears people out****.

有些孩子非常好動，會****把身邊的人累得筋疲力盡****。

Practice 2

> Looking after three young children all day really ****wore me out****.

整天照顧三個小孩真的****把我累壞了****。

Practice 3

> The long journey ****wore everyone out****.

那段漫長的旅程****把大家都累得筋疲力盡****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****wear someone out = 使某人因持續的活動、壓力或負擔而極度疲累****

17. ****be worn out (人) — 筋疲力盡的****

Practice 1

> I'm completely ****worn out**** after work.

我下班後已經****累得筋疲力盡****。

Practice 2

> She looked ****worn out**** after caring for the baby all night.

她整晚照顧嬰兒後，看起來****疲憊不堪****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****worn out = 極度疲倦、精力幾乎耗盡的****

18. ****wear off (效果、感覺逐漸消失) — 逐漸消退；失去效力****

A very common phrasal extension.

Practice 1

> The painkiller is beginning to **wear off**.

止痛藥的藥效開始**消退**。

Practice 2

> The excitement soon **wore off**.

那種興奮感很快便**逐漸消退**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****wear off = 某種效果、感覺或影響隨時間逐漸減弱直至消失****

19. **wear thin (物質) — 磨薄**

Literal use.

Practice 1

> The fabric has **worn thin** at the elbows.

手肘位置的布料已經**磨薄了**。

Practice 2

> The soles of his shoes were **wearing thin**.

他的鞋底正在逐漸**磨薄**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****wear thin = 因長期使用或摩擦而逐漸變薄****

20. **wear thin (耐性 / 藉口等) — 逐漸失去效力；開始令人厭煩**

A very useful figurative extension.

Practice 1

> My patience is beginning to **wear thin**.

我的耐性開始**快要耗盡**了。

Practice 2

> His excuses are **wearing thin**.

他的藉口已經**愈來愈令人難以接受**。

MCQ-ready definition:

wear thin = 耐性、藉口或某事物的效果逐漸減弱，開始不足或令人厭煩

21. **wear well** (衣物 / 物件耐用) — 耐穿；耐用

Practice 1

> This material **wears well**.

這種物料很**耐用 / 耐穿**。

Practice 2

> Good leather shoes usually **wear well**.

優質皮鞋通常很**耐穿**。

MCQ-ready definition:

wear well = 經長時間使用後仍能保持良好狀態

22. **wear well** (人不顯老) — 保養得好；不顯年紀

A figurative extension.

Practice 1

> She has **worn well** and looks much younger than her age.

她**保養得很好**，看起來比實際年齡年輕很多。

Practice 2

> He has **worn well** over the years.

這些年來他一直**不太顯老**。

MCQ-ready definition:

wear well = 隨着年齡增長仍保持良好、年輕的外表

23. **wear badly** — 不耐用；容易磨損

Practice 1

> Cheap fabric often **wears badly**.

便宜布料通常**不耐用**。

Practice 2

> These shoes have **worn badly** after only a few months.

這雙鞋只穿了幾個月便**磨損得很嚴重**。

MCQ-ready definition:

wear badly = 經使用後很快變舊或磨損

24. **wear (noun)** — 磨損；損耗

As a noun, **wear** describes damage caused by continued use.

Practice 1

> The tyres showed signs of **wear**.

那些輪胎出現了**磨損**跡象。

Practice 2

> Regular maintenance can reduce **wear** on the engine.

定期保養可以減少引擎的**損耗**。

MCQ-ready definition:

****wear = 因長時間使用或摩擦造成的逐漸損耗****

25. ****wear and tear — 日常使用造成的磨損；損耗****

A very common fixed expression.

Practice 1

> The furniture has suffered a lot of ****wear and tear****.

這些家具因長期使用而有很多****磨損****。

Practice 2

> The landlord accepts normal ****wear and tear****.

業主接受正常使用造成的****自然損耗****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****wear and tear = 因正常、長期使用而自然出現的損耗或破損****

26. ****wear (某類服裝) —服裝****

****Wear**** also appears productively in clothing-category compounds.

Examples include:

* ****sportswear**** — 運動服

* ****swimwear**** — 泳裝

* ****underwear**** — 內衣

* ****nightwear**** — 睡衣

* ****footwear**** — 鞋類

* ****menswear**** — 男裝

* ****womenswear**** — 女裝

* ****formal wear**** — 正式服裝

Practice 1

> The shop specializes in ****sportswear****.

這家店專門售賣****運動服裝****。

Practice 2

> Guests are expected to wear **formal wear** in the evening.

晚上賓客應穿着**正式服裝**。

MCQ-ready definition:

-wear = 某一用途、場合或類別的衣服 / 穿戴物

27. **everyday wear** — 日常穿着的衣服

Practice 1

> These trousers are designed for **everyday wear**.

這條長褲適合**日常穿着**。

Practice 2

> The shoes are comfortable enough for **everyday wear**.

這雙鞋很舒服，適合**日常穿着**。

MCQ-ready definition:

wear = 作某種用途穿着的衣服或服裝類別

28. **wearable** (adjective) — 可穿戴的；適合穿的

Practice 1

> The designer creates stylish but **wearable** clothes.

這位設計師創作時尚但又**適合實際穿着的**衣服。

Practice 2

> The device is small enough to be **wearable**.

這部裝置體積夠小，可以**穿戴在身上**。

MCQ-ready definition:

wearable = 可以穿戴在身上，或適合實際穿着的

29. **wearable (noun) — 穿戴式裝置**

A modern lexicalized noun, usually referring to electronic technology worn on the body.

Practice 1

> Smartwatches are among the most common **wearables**.

智能手錶是最常見的**穿戴式裝置**之一。

Practice 2

> Health **wearables** can track heart rate and physical activity.

健康類**穿戴式裝置**可以追蹤心率和身體活動。

MCQ-ready definition:

wearable = 可佩戴在身上的電子或智能裝置

30. **wearer — 穿着者 ; 佩戴者**

Practice 1

> The helmet protects the **wearer** from head injuries.

這個頭盔可以保護**佩戴者**免受頭部受傷。

Practice 2

> The glasses automatically adjust to suit the **wearer**.

這副眼鏡會自動調節以配合**佩戴者**。

MCQ-ready definition:

wearer = 穿着或佩戴某件物品的人

Important distinction 1: **wear vs put on**

This is essential.

put on

= the **action of dressing**

> She **put on** her coat.

她**穿上了**外套。

wear

= the resulting **state**

> She is **wearing** her coat.

她正**穿着**外套。

So:

put on → 穿上

wear → 穿着

Important distinction 2: **wear vs dress**

wear

Usually followed by the item:

> She **wears jeans**.

她穿牛仔褲。

dress

Often describes the act/style of putting clothes on yourself or someone else:

> She **dressed quickly**.

她很快便穿好衣服。

> She **dressed the baby**.

她替嬰兒穿衣服。

Also:

> She **dresses well**.

她很會穿衣打扮。

Important distinction 3: **wear vs carry**

Wear means something is attached to or positioned on your body as clothing/accessory.

> **wear** a watch

> 戴手錶

Carry means hold or transport something.

> **carry** a bag

> 拿 / 攜帶袋子

But:

> **wear a backpack**

means the backpack is actually on your shoulders/back.

Important distinction 4: **wore vs worn**

wore

simple past

> She **wore** a red dress yesterday.

她昨天穿了一條紅色裙子。

worn

past participle

> She has **worn** that dress before.

她以前穿過那條裙子。

Also adjective:

> **worn** shoes

磨舊了的鞋

So:

* wear

* **wore**

* **worn**

Important distinction 5: **worn vs worn-out**

worn

shows signs of use

> a **worn** carpet

> 一張**磨舊了的**地毯

worn-out

much more severe

> a **worn-out** carpet

> 一張**嚴重磨損的**地毯

For people:

> I'm **worn out**.

我**筋疲力盡**。

But normally not:

>  I'm worn.

for simply meaning 「我很累」.

Important distinction 6: **wear out vs wear down**

Both can involve gradual damage, but their common patterns differ.

wear out

Often means become so damaged through use that it is no longer useful.

> The shoes **wore out**.

鞋子**穿破了**。

Also:

> The children **wore me out**.

孩子們**把我累壞了**。

wear down

Emphasizes gradual reduction through repeated pressure/friction.

> The steps were **worn down**.

梯級被**磨低了**。

> They eventually **wore him down**.

他們最後逐漸**磨掉了他的抵抗意志**。

Important distinction 7: **wear someone out vs tire someone out**

They are extremely close.

> The trip **wore me out**.

> The trip **tired me out**.

Both:

這趟旅程把我累壞了。

But **wear out** often suggests **energy being gradually used up**, which fits your sentence particularly well.

Important distinction 8: **wear out vs exhaust**

wear someone out

Very natural and conversational.

> The kids **wore me out**.

孩子們把我累壞了。

exhaust someone

Stronger and somewhat more formal.

> The experience **exhausted** him.

那次經歷令他筋疲力盡。

Both can describe extreme tiredness, but **wear out** often emphasizes the cumulative process.

Important distinction 9: **wear off vs wear out**

wear off

an **effect or feeling disappears**

> The medicine **wore off**.

藥效消退了。

wear out

an **object becomes unusable**, or a **person becomes exhausted**

> The shoes **wore out**.

鞋穿破了。

> The work **wore me out**.

工作把我累壞了。

Important distinction 10: **wear away vs wear off**

wear away

Usually physical material gradually disappears:

> Water **wore away** the rock.

水逐漸侵蝕岩石。

wear off

Usually an effect, feeling, pain, excitement, novelty, etc. gradually disappears:

> The excitement **wore off**.

興奮感逐漸消退。

Important distinction 11: **wear thin literal vs figurative**

Literal

> The material has **worn thin**.

布料已經**磨薄了**。

Figurative

> My patience is **wearing thin**.

我的耐性**快耗盡了**。

Same underlying image:

something gradually becomes thinner → something gradually becomes weaker or less sufficient

Important distinction 12: **wear a smile vs have a smile**

Both can describe a smile, but:

have a smile

simply describes its presence.

wear a smile

presents the smile as something visibly carried on the face, often with a slightly more descriptive/literary quality.

> She **wore a gentle smile**.

她臉上**帶着溫柔的微笑**。

Important distinction 13: **wear well — two meanings**

This expression has two especially useful branches.

Object

> These shoes **wear well**.

這些鞋子很**耐穿**。

Person

> She has **worn well**.

她**保養得很好 / 不顯老**。

The figurative human use develops naturally from the idea of **remaining in good condition over time**.

Family-extension note

****Wear**** is a particularly strong polysemy family because it has several genuinely distinct but historically connected semantic branches:

1. ****having clothing or objects on the body****
2. ****displaying an expression or appearance****
3. ****gradual physical damage through use/friction****
4. ****gradual psychological or physical exhaustion****
5. ****clothing categories****, as in ****sportswear****

6. modern **wearable** technology

The phrasal extensions are especially important here. **Wear out**, **wear down**, **wear off**, and **wear away** are not just random combinations: each has become a highly conventional modern expression with a predictable but distinct learner meaning.

For this project, they are worth including because your original sentence itself depends on **wear someone out**, not on the basic clothing meaning of **wear**.

Master comparison

Form / expression	Traditional Chinese	Core idea
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wear clothes	穿着衣服	have clothing on body
wear shoes	穿着鞋	have footwear on
wear glasses	戴眼鏡	have accessory on
wear jewellery/watch	戴首飾 / 手錶	have accessory on
wear make-up/perfume	化妝 / 用香水	have substance applied
wear your hair long	留長髮	have hair in a style
wear a smile	面帶微笑	display expression
wear a puzzled look	面露困惑	display facial emotion
wear (material)	磨損	deteriorate through use
wear something smooth	把某物磨平 / 磨光	friction changes surface
wear away	磨掉 ; 侵蝕	gradually disappear physically
wear something down	磨薄 / 磨低	gradual physical reduction
wear someone down	消磨某人	gradually weaken
wear someone down into agreeing	磨到某人讓步	weaken resistance
wear out (object)	穿破 ; 用壞	become unusable
worn out (object)	嚴重磨損的	damaged through use
wear someone out	把某人累壞	exhaust someone
worn out (person)	筋疲力盡的	extremely tired
wear off	逐漸消退	effect disappears
wear thin (material)	磨薄	physically become thin
patience wears thin	耐性逐漸耗盡	figurative weakening
excuses wear thin	藉口愈來愈站不住腳	lose effectiveness
wear well (object)	耐用 ; 耐穿	remain in good condition
wear well (person)	保養得好 ; 不顯老	age well
wear (noun)	磨損 ; 損耗	damage from use
wear and tear	日常損耗	normal deterioration
sportswear	運動服	clothing category
formal wear	正式服裝	clothing category
footwear	鞋類	things worn on feet
wearable (adj.)	可穿戴的	able/suitable to be worn
wearable (n.)	穿戴式裝置	body-worn technology

| **wearer** | 穿戴者 | person wearing something |

For your original sentence

> Some children are active in a way that **wears people out**, but Leo is different.

The exact expression is:

wear someone out = 把某人累壞；使某人筋疲力盡

Here, **wear** carries the metaphorical idea of someone's **energy gradually being used up**, just as an object gradually gets worn down through repeated use.

So the semantic path is particularly nice:

physical wear 磨損

→ **gradually use something up**

→ **wear a person out 把人的精力耗盡**

A natural Traditional Chinese translation is:

> 有些孩子非常好動，**會把身邊的人累得筋疲力盡**，但 Leo 不一樣。

For this passage, **wear someone out** is the key sense—not **wear clothes**.